more reliable than a person who has only had a line of credit for six months. Because of this, you don't want to constantly open and close accounts, because it is going to bring down your average "age of account." Additionally, even if you do not use a credit card very often, you should keep it open because the age of the card is helping boost your score. The exception to this is if the card comes with high fees for keeping it open.

4. **New credit: accounts for 10% of your score.** Your score also depends on how many new accounts you have applied for and how many you have. Applying for too many new accounts and having a lot of new accounts open is going to hurt your credit score.
5. **Types of credit in use: accounts for 10% of your score.** The final thing the FICO formula considers in determining your credit score is whether you have a mix of different types of credit, such as credit cards, store accounts, auto loans, and mortgages. It also looks at how many total accounts you have. Since this is a small component of your score, don't worry if you don't have accounts in each of these categories, and don't open new accounts just to increase your mix of credit types.